

YOUR FIRST PAPER

A Field Guide to Phloem

A calm, local-first desk for reading papers, leaving useful traces, and finding your way back.



Start here

1

Choose this note

On the wall, one click selects a paper and shows its field notebook.

2

Open the notebook

Click the selected note again, or choose Continue reading.

3

Make one trace

Move the guide, mark a sentence, or write a short margin note.

01 - GATHER

Build a reading wall

The wall is a working surface, not an inbox to conquer. Keep what helps you think.

1

Add a paper

Drop a PDF or folder, paste a direct PDF link, or pick from your connected GitHub folder.

2

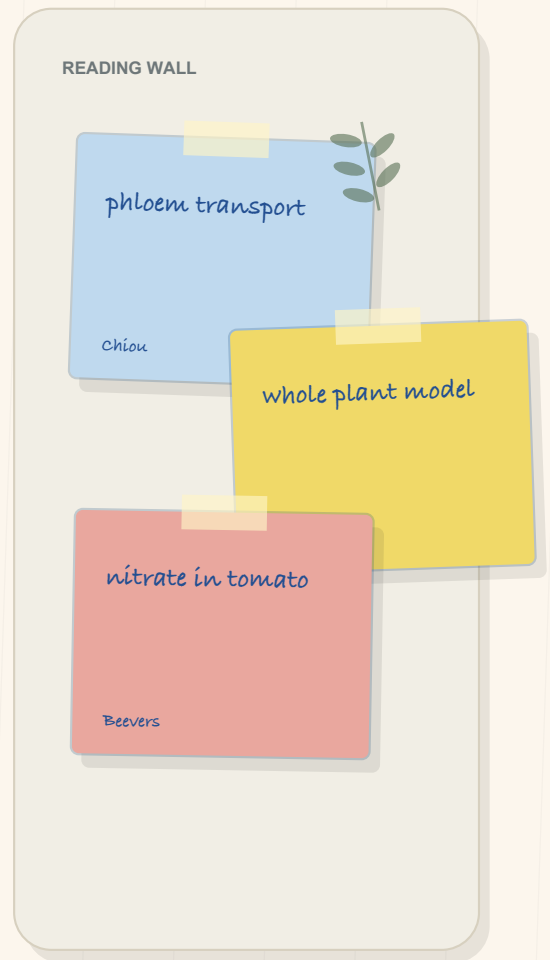
Select with one click

The note straightens and its notebook appears beside the wall. Click again to start reading.

3

Find it later

Search titles, authors, and tags. Sort by last touched, date added, title, author, or progress.



Tip: tags create useful connections between papers without forcing a folder system.

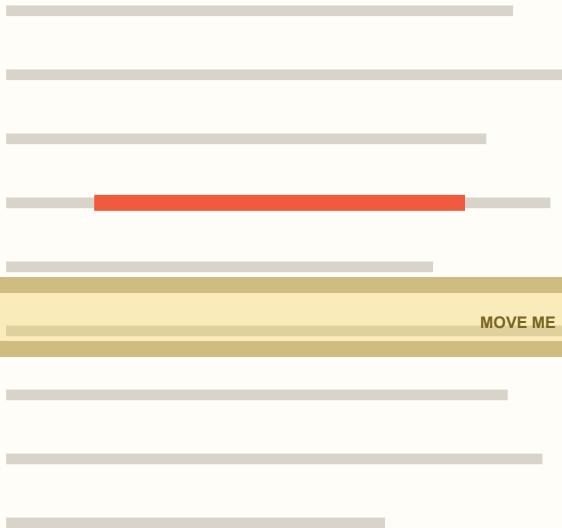
02 - FOCUS

Read with less friction

The page stays central. Tools appear around it only when they help.

Pressure flow in the phloem

A small sample page



Guide

Starts yellow and full-page; drag it to hold your line.

Fit / zoom

Make dense figures and small labels comfortable.

Reflow

Switch to rebuilt text when the original page is cramped.

Recall

Hide the page briefly and explain the idea in your own words.

03 - NOTICE

Think beside the passage

Select once, then keep the highlight, note, definition, and AI thread together on the page.

MARK**Reopen the mark**

Select a saved highlight to reopen its note, colors, AI, and eraser - never a duplicate.

NOTE**Write for return**

Write the smallest note that restores the context; it stays with the highlight.

DEFINE**Resolve a term**

Select a short term for a definition and a source-linked image.

ASK AI**Start a thread**

Start a thread beside the passage. Related highlight, page, and paper notes are included.

If a note cannot help you re-enter the thought, make it smaller.

04 - REMEMBER

Return without a streak

Phloem keeps questions near the paper. Review is a shelf you can visit, not a score that chases you.



A good saved question

What evidence would make this mechanism fail?

05 - KEEP

A desk that travels carefully

Papers and notes begin on this device. Add sync only when it makes your own workflow safer.

LOCAL FIRST

Your library works without an account. PDFs live in this browser's local storage.

OPTIONAL SYNC

Use Google Drive app data, or encrypted GitHub sync, when you need the same library on several devices.

BACKUP

Export a portable JSON backup for notes and metadata. Keep original PDFs separately too.

BROWSER EXTENSION

Send web or local PDFs from Chrome. For files on your computer, enable Allow access to file URLs once.

Your first five minutes

1. Open this guide
2. Move the reading bar
3. Mark one line
4. Write one margin note
5. Return to the wall

